

These are also called the five classes designated as *Kavarga*, *Chavarga*, *Tavarga*, *Tavarga*, and *Pavarga* respectively.

(b) Semivowels—य y, र, र, ल l, व v.

(c) Sibilants—श श् sh, स s.

(d) Sonant Aspirate—ह h.

Besides these we have two more characters occurring in the Veda, viz. ऌ and ॡ (often substituted for इ and ए; as ईळे for ईडे, मीळहुषे for मीहुषे &c.) In Maráthi ऌ is generally substituted for the final ल of Sanskrit words.

§ 5. The first two letters of the five classes and the sibilants are called *sunds* or *hard consonants*. The rest are called *sonants* or *soft consonants*.

§ 6. In addition to the characters given above there are in Sanskrit two nasal sounds:—the one called *Anusvāra*, is denoted by [˙] i. e. a dot placed above the letter after which it is to be pronounced, e. g. कं; the other, called *Anunāsika* is denoted by ° i. e. a dot within a semi-circle placed above the letter after which it is to be pronounced e. g. कैं.

(a) And a sort of hard breathing is known as Visarga (generally called Visarjanīya by Sanskrit grammarians). It is denoted by the sign : i. e. two vertical dots placed after the letter after which it is to be pronounced. In pronunciation it is a harder aspirate than ह्. The Visarga is not an original character but only a substitute for a final स s or र r.

(b) Jihvámūliya (जिह्वामूलिय) and Upadhmanīya (उपध्मानीय) are terms given to a sort of Semi-Visarga, when pronounced before क् ख्, and प् फ् respectively. It is written symbolically